

## Union Budget 2026 boosts MeitY with ₹216.33 billion

The Union Budget 2026-27 raised MeitY's allocation to ₹216.33 billion, prioritising AI, semiconductors, and electronics components. Key initiatives include the announcement of ISM 2.0, nearly double the allocation of ₹80 billion for semiconductor manufacturing, and ₹10 billion for the IndiaAI Mission. Electronics hardware support was further strengthened with ₹15 billion for ECMS.



Representational image

## Defence ministry bags ₹7.85 trillion in Budget 2026

Marking a 15.19% increase, the Union Budget 2026-27 allocated a record ₹7.85 trillion to the Ministry of Defence, with a strong emphasis on domestic procurement. ₹1.39 trillion (75% of capital acquisition) will be

directed towards Indian industry, boosting supply chains and creating jobs. Upcoming acquisitions include fighter jets, UAVs, and drones, reinforcing India's focus on self-reliance and strategic military modernisation.

## PEOPLE (on the move)

### Josh Foulger exits Zetwerk Electronics to join Dixon



Zetwerk confirmed the departure of Business Head Josh Foulger as the manufacturing unicorn prepares for an IPO. Foulger, who built Zetwerk's electronics vertical, will join Dixon Technologies' Padget Electronics as President of IT Hardware and New Projects from February 2026. His departure follows other leadership reshuffles, coinciding with

Zetwerk's ₹10 billion expansion plans.

### Kiran Kumar N. appointed SVP of Semiconductor and Systems at Qubika

Qubika has named Kiran Kumar N. as Senior Vice President of Semiconductor and Systems, based in the Bay Area. Joining in January 2026, he will drive the go-to-market strategy and expand the global reach of Latin American engineering teams. With 24 years of experience in embedded systems, Kumar previously held senior roles at Tessolve, leading AI, IoT, and connectivity initiatives.



### Deepak Rastogi becomes the new CFO of Ola Electric



Ola Electric has appointed veteran finance leader Deepak Rastogi as CFO, effective January 20, 2026. With 30+ years across automotive, manufacturing, chemicals, and real estate, most recently as Puravankara's group CFO, Rastogi steps in at a critical time. Analysts expect his financial discipline and execution skills to help Ola stabilise sales and

reclaim e-scooter market momentum.

### Elektronika Sales names Parag Kulkarni as National Lead

Elektronika Sales has appointed Parag Kulkarni as National Business Development Manager in February 2026, bolstering its leadership amid rising semiconductor demand. With 30+ years' experience at Microchip, WPG, and Silicon Micro Systems, plus investment expertise at Next Orbit Ventures, Kulkarni will expand market reach, forge alliances, and drive growth across automotive, industrial, telecom, and IoT sectors.

